



Deleting Many Hyperlinks

If you inherit worksheets from other people, you may find that some worksheets contain many, many hyperlinks. These hyperlinks are often automatically created by Excel as you import or enter information in the worksheet. If you want to delete these hyperlinks, you can do so by right-clicking on them and choosing **Hyperlink > Remove Hyperlink** from the Context menu. Doing this with dozens or hundreds of hyperlinks can consume a huge amount of time. To delete all the hyperlinks in the active worksheet at the same time, you can use a one-line macro:

```
Sub DeleteHyper()  
ActiveSheet.Hyperlinks.
```

Delete

```
End Sub
```

Select the worksheet you want to affect, and run the macro!



Recalculate Formulas

There are two ways Excel recalculates formulas—automatic and manual. Go to **Tools > Options**, and click the Calculations tab. Select 'Automatic Update' if you wish to have Excel always update your data. Select 'Manual Update' if you wish to have Excel update formulas only when you tell it to. Under Manual Update:

[F9]: Calculates all worksheets in all open workbooks. When a portion of a formula is selected, it calculates the selected portion. You can then press [Enter] (or [Ctrl] + [Shift] + [Enter] for array formulas); Replaces the selected portion with the calculated value.

[Shift] + [F9]: Calculates the active worksheet.

[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [F9]: Calculates all worksheets in all open workbooks, regardless of whether they have changed since the last calculation.

[Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Shift] + [F9]: Checks dependent formulas and then calculates all cells in all open workbooks, including cells not marked as needing to be calculated.



Opening An HTML Page In Excel

Excel is "Web aware," meaning that the program knows how to handle hyperlinks. You can add a hyperlink in a document, click on that link, and Excel opens your Web browser and displays the contents of that link in the browser. (You can also create a hyperlink to other Office documents, including Excel workbooks.) You can even create hyperlinks to different objects on your worksheet, such as a command button in a form.

What if you want to start the browser and open an HTML file from within a VBA macro? There are a couple of ways that you can do this. The first is to simply open a new Internet Explorer object within your code. A macro to do this would look like this:

```
Sub DoBrowse1()  
Dim ie As Object  
Set ie =  
CreateObject("Internetexplor  
er.Application")  
ie.Visible = True  
ie.Navigate  
"c:\temp\MyHTMLfile.htm"  
End Sub
```

This macro will open the file "c:\temp\MyHTMLfile.htm" in a new Internet Explorer window. If you want to instead open a Web page from over the Internet, you can do so simply by changing where you want to navigate—replace the file path with a URL.

Another way to accomplish the same task is to rely on Excel to figure out what your default browser is and open the HTML resource. Use the following macro:

```
Sub DoBrowse2()  
ActiveWorkbook.FollowH  
yperlink _  
Address:="c:\temp\MyHT  
MLfile.htm", _  
NewWindow:=True  
End Sub
```

Again, the browser opens a new window and displays the specified file. You can change the Address parameter to any URL you want.



Data In A Single Column

Say you use a program to create a CSV file. This file can then be opened in Excel for further analysis. When you double-click the CSV file in Windows, Excel starts and loads the file. The problem is that the file, when opened, isn't parsed by Excel. Instead of the comma-separated values being in different columns, every record appears in a single column. The reason for this is quite simple, and has to do with the format in which the data is stored in the CSV file by the non-Excel program. To understand that, you need to understand how Excel opens CSV files.

When you open a CSV file in Excel, the program treats any commas in the file as delimiters. You cannot override this automatic filtering when opening the file. So, how does Excel treat the incoming data? Consider that the CSV file contains the following four records:

```
a,b,c,d,e  
"a,b,c,d",e  
a,"b,c",d,e  
"a,b,c,d,e"
```

As far as Excel is concerned, the first record has five fields, separated by commas. The second record has only two fields, "a,b,c,d" and "e." In other words, Excel ignores any commas that may appear between the quote marks. Given the effect that inverted commas have, the third record has only four fields, and the fourth record is interpreted to have only a single field.

What this has to do with the CSV file loading incorrectly is that it is very possible that the program creating the CSV file is putting a pair of inverted commas around each record. This would cause everything in the record to be treated as a single field by Excel, which means it ends up in a single column when the CSV file is loaded.

There are a couple of ways to verify this. The first is to simply open the CSV file with Notepad and look at each record. Another way is to rename the CSV file so that its extension is not '.csv' but

'.txt'. When you open this file within Excel, the Text Import Wizard starts. Choose 'Delimited', click 'Next', and then you can see what delimiters are chosen. Pay attention to the Text Qualifier; if you change it, you can immediately see at the bottom of the dialog box how Excel interprets the file's records.

If you find that there are extra inverted commas around each record in the CSV file, there are three things you can do.

The first is to change the program that creates the CSV file so that it doesn't add the extra inverted commas—you'll then be able to import with no problem.

The second is to go ahead and load the CSV file into Excel, such that each record is in column A. The surrounding inverted commas will be gone, stripped out by the import process. This means that you can now use Data > Text to Columns to separate the data in column A into individual columns.

The third thing you can do is to create a macro that will open the CSV file and parse it for you. This is particularly helpful if you will be opening, over time, many CSV files that have the exact same format. Your macro could be as elaborate as desired, even formatting columns and processing data as it is imported.

Linux

Some Linux distros such as Fedora don't play back MP3 or AVI files. Users have to go through the ordeal of getting them to work on their machine. Here we will see how to install XMMS player to play MP3 files on a Fedora Core 3 box, permanently create aliases for long commands, use cdcrecord to burn CDs, and installing an alternative for MSN messenger.

These tips can be very useful for those new to Linux. We will be using Fedora Core 3 for this purpose.